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CULTURE

INTRODUCTION

According to Taylor, culture is "that complex-whole which includes knowledge, belief, art, moral, law, custom and any other capabilities and habits acquired by man as a member of society" (plus material culture). Culture, according to Taylor, is a complete self-working system of human achievements. These achievements categorized into material and non-material objects are the elements of self-moving units of culture. By way of simplicity, we consider culture as an interrelated unit of its interdependent parts. This interdependence of composing elements makes a web of interrelationship within itself to make the system of culture work as a complex-whole.

Definitions

Herskovits defined culture as: ***"man-made part of environment"***.

According to Linton: ***"The culture is social heredity which is transmitted from, one generation to other with the accumulation of individual experiences."***

Beals and Hoijer hold that a culture is ***"the totality of designs for living practiced by man at all places and times."*** Within all the time and space a culture is the mode of activities which differentiates the people of one society from another.

From Lowie's point of view a culture is ***"the whole of social tradition,"*** which resembles in sense with Linton's attitude on the point.

Culture is "the continually changing patterns of learned behaviour and the products of learned behaviour (including attitude, values,

knowledge and material objects) which are shared by and transmitted among the members of the society."

In general, the culture is not a biological phenomenon but is learned by the members of society to follow a given way of life. It is the matter of adaptation in environment by people which paves their way of life in society.

CHARACTERISTICS OF CULTURE

The definitions cited above reveal some of the characteristics of culture. For a clear understanding of the concept of culture, it is necessary for us to know its main features,

i. Culture is Learnt: Culture is not inherited biologically, but learnt socially by man. It is not an inborn tendency. There is no cultural instinct as such. Culture is often called 'learned ways of behaviour'. Unlearned behaviour, such as closing the eyes while sleeping, the eye blinking reflex and so on, are purely physiological and not cultural. Shaking hands or saying 'Salam' or 'thanks' and shaving.

ii. Culture is Social: Culture does not exist in isolation. Neither is it an individual phenomenon. It is a product of society. It originates and develops through social interactions. It is shared by the members of society. No man can acquire culture without association with other human beings.

iii. Culture is Shared: Culture in the sociological sense, is something shared. It is not something that an individual alone can possess. For example, customs, traditions, beliefs, ideas, values, morals, etc., are all shared by people of a group or society.

iv. Culture is Transmissive: Culture is capable of being transmitted from one generation to the next. Parents pass on culture traits to their children and they in turn to their children, and so on. Culture is transmitted not through genes but by means of language. Language is the main vehicle of culture. Language in its different forms like reading, writing and speaking makes it possible for the present generation to understand the achievements of earlier generations.

v. Culture is Continuous and Cumulative: Culture exists as a continuous process. In its historical growth it tends to become cumulative. Culture is a 'growing

whole' which includes in itself, the achievements of the past and the present and makes provision for the future achievements of mankind. "Culture may thus be conceived of as a kind of stream flowing down through the centuries from one generation to another".

vi. Culture is Consistent and Integrated: Culture, in its development has revealed a tendency to be consistent. At the same time different parts of culture are interconnected. For example, the value system of a society is closely connected with its other aspects such as morality, religion, customs, traditions, beliefs, and so on. Change in one part of culture will cause change in rest of the parts.

vii. Culture is Dynamic and Adaptive: Though culture is relatively stable it is not altogether static. It is subject to slow but constant changes. Change and growth are latent in culture. Culture is responsive to the changing conditions of the physical world. It is adaptive. It also intervenes in the natural environment and helps man in his process of adjustment.

viii. Culture is Gratifying: Culture provides proper opportunities and prescribes means for the satisfaction of our needs and desires. These needs may be biological or social in nature. Our need for food, shelter, and clothing on the one hand, and our desire for status, name, fame, money, mates, etc., are all, for example, fulfilled according to the cultural ways.

ix. Culture Varies from Society to Society: Every society has a culture of its own. It differs from society to society. Culture of every society is unique to itself. Cultures are not uniform. Cultural elements such as customs, traditions, morals, ideals, values, ideologies, beliefs, practices, philosophies, institutions, etc., are not uniform everywhere. Ways of eating, speaking, greeting, dressing, entertaining, living, etc., of different societies differ significantly. Culture varies from time to time also. No culture ever remains constant or changeless.

x. Culture is Super Organic and Ideational: Culture is sometimes called 'the super organic'. By 'super organic' Herbert Spencer meant that culture is neither organic nor inorganic in nature but above these two. The term implies the social meaning of physical objects and physiological acts. The social meaning may be independent of physiological and physical properties and characteristics. For example, the social meaning of a national flag is not just 'a piece of colored cloth'.

The flag represents a nation. Similarly, priests and prisoners, professors and professionals, players, engineers and doctors, farmers and soldiers, and others are not just biological beings. They are viewed in their society differently. Their social status and role can be understood only through culture.

Further, every society considers its culture as an ideal. It is regarded as an end in itself. It is intrinsically valuable. The people are also aware of their culture as an ideal one. They are proud of their cultural heritage.

TYPES OF CULTURE

Types of culture are given below:

Real Culture

It is that culture which can be observed in our social life. The culture on which we act upon in our social life is real. The part of culture which the people adopt in their social life is their real culture. The whole of the culture is never real because a part of it remains without practice. How far we set upon Islam is our real culture. We are all Muslims but we do not follow Islam fully in our social life. It means the part of Islam which we follow is our real culture.

Ideal Culture

The culture which is presented as a pattern or precedent to the people is called ideal. It is the goal of the society. It can never be achieved fully because some part of it remains out of practice. This culture is explained in books, speeches and guidance. The part of ideal culture practiced in social life is called real culture. Islam is our ideal culture. We claim to be true Muslims and this claim is our ideal culture but how far we are Muslims in practice is our real culture. Both the real and ideal cultures are related together and different from each other.

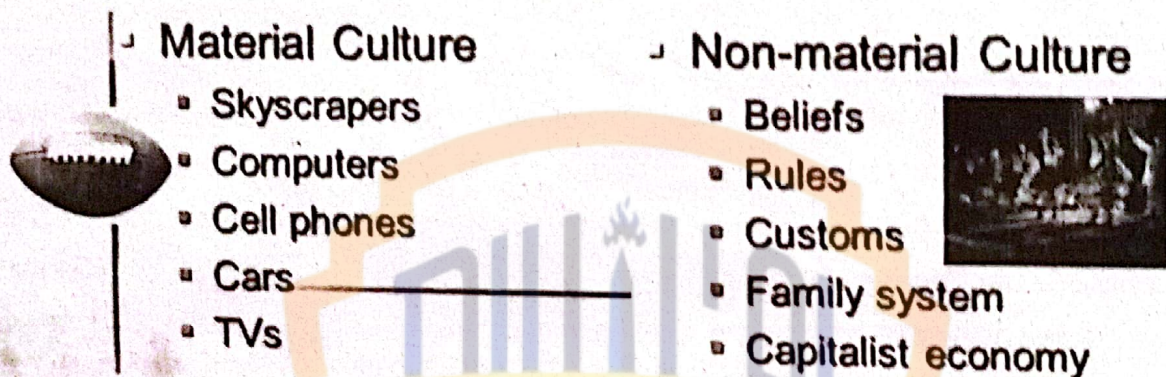


(i) **Material Culture:** according to John J. Maccionis, "Material culture, by

contrast, is the physical things created by members of a society, everything from armchairs to zippers".

Examples:

Material culture consists of man-made objects such as tools, implements, furniture, automobiles, buildings, dams, roads, bridges, and in fact, the physical substance which has been changed and used by man. It is concerned with the external, mechanical and utilitarian objects. It includes technical and material equipment's like a printing press, a locomotive, a telephone, a television, a tractor, a machine gun, etc. It includes our banks, parliaments, insurance schemes, currency systems, etc. It is referred to as civilization.



(ii) Non-Material Culture: according to John J. Maccionis, "*Nonmaterial culture is the ideas created by members of a society, ideas that range from art to Zen*".

Examples:

Non-material culture consists of the words the people use or the language they speak, the beliefs they hold, values and virtues they cherish, habits they follow, rituals and practices that they do and the ceremonies they observe. It also includes our customs and tastes, attitudes and outlook, in brief, our ways of acting, feeling and thinking.

FUNCTIONS OF CULTURE

Culture has been fulfilling a number of functions among which the following may be noted.

i. Culture is the Treasury of Knowledge. Culture provides knowledge which is essential for the physical, social and intellectual existence of man. Culture preserves

knowledge and helps its transmission from generation to generation through its element, that is, language. Language helps not only the transmission of knowledge but also its preservation, accumulation and diffusion. On the contrary, animals do not have this advantage. Because, culture does not exist at sub-human level.

ii. Culture Defines Situations. Culture defines social situations for us. It not only defines but also conditions and determines - what we eat and drink, what we wear, when to laugh, weep, sleep, love, to make friends with, what work we do, what God we worship, what knowledge we rely upon, what poetry we recite and so on.

iii. Culture Defines Attitudes, Values and Goals. Attitudes refer to the tendency to feel and act in certain ways. Values are the measure of goodness or desirability. Goals refer to the attainments which our values define as worthy. It is the culture which conditions our attitude towards various issues such as religion, morality, marriage, science, family planning, prostitution and so on.

iv. Culture Decides our Career. Whether we should become a politician, a social worker, a doctor, an engineer, a soldier, a farmer, a professor, an industrialist, a religious leader, and so on is decided by our culture. What career we are likely to pursue is largely decided by our culture.

v. Culture Provides Behaviour Pattern. Culture directs and confines the behaviour of an individual. Culture assigns goals and provides means for achieving them. It rewards his noble works and punishes the ignoble ones.

vi. Culture Moulds Personality. Culture exercises a great influence on the development of personality. No child can develop human qualities in the absence of a cultural environment. Culture prepares man for group life and provides him the design of living. It is the culture that provides opportunities for the development of personality and sets limits on its growth.

ELEMENTS OF CULTURE

Culture is the totality of learned and socially transmitted behaviors. It is shared and practicing in all societies of the world. Basic Elements of culture includes ideas, beliefs, values, customs which make it a whole configuration. Culture is transmitted from one generation to another. Each culture has some basic elements.

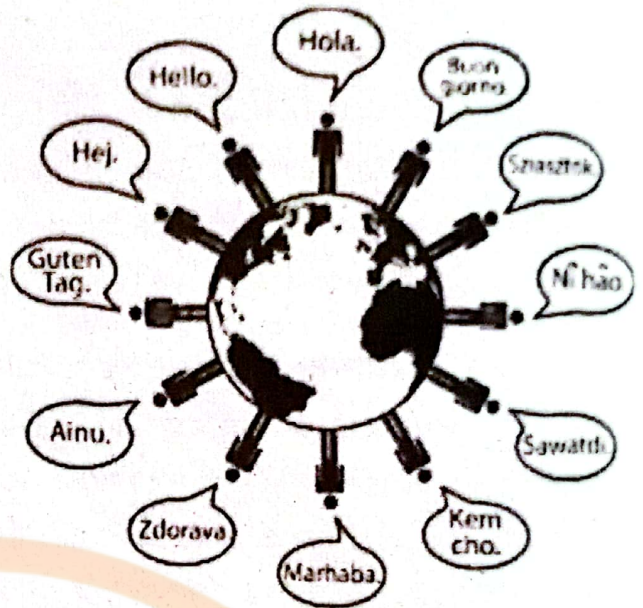
There are some basic Cultural Elements given below:

1. Language

According to John J. Maccionis:

"Language, the key to the world of culture, is a system of symbols that allows people to communicate with one another." Humans have created many alphabets to express the hundreds of languages we speak.

A group of words or ideas having common meaning and is shared to a social situation is called language. Language is the entrance to a culture. Language is a set of socially sound pattern, words, and sentences having specific meaning and terminology common to the same culture. You can learn effects of ethnocentrism.



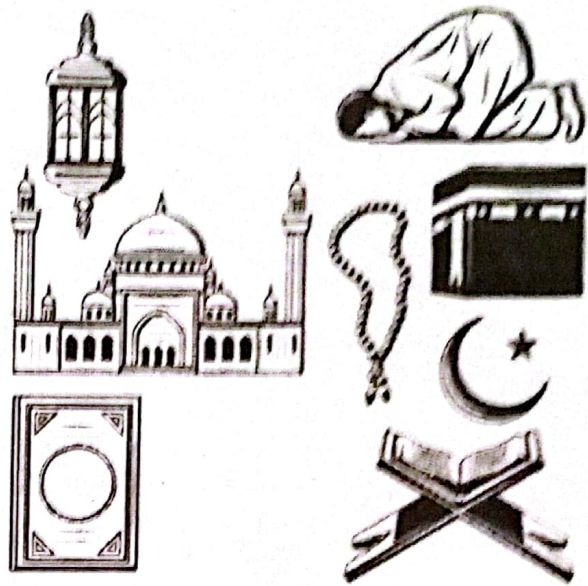
Language is a source of communication and to transmit message from one person to another. It is the method to mold the behavior and experience of a person. Language differs from culture to culture and is transmitted from one generation to another.

Language is like a vehicle through which we can carry out our complex social activities. Language is the foundation of a culture and ticket to the entrance of a social life. Animal have not culture because they have no specific language to transmit words to others. So, language is the key to open a social life of an individual with some special characteristics.

2. Symbols

According to John J. Maccionis: **"A symbol is anything that carries a particular meaning recognized by people who share a culture."** A word, a whistle, a wall covered with graffiti, a flashing red light, a raised fist—all serve as symbols.

A symbol is anything that is used to stand for something else. Culture is a system of symbols. Symbols are anything used to represent express and stand for an event situation. Symbols direct to guide our behavior. It is used to show an event of past, present or future. For example the heap of ash show that the something has been burnt or the wet street shows that it has rained.



Islamic symbols part of belief system

Bowing head, whistling, winking of eyes situation, all are the symbols, which express a specific object idea about other. Bait-Ullah is the symbol of God and we pray to it. American Shake their hand to

answer for No. Other examples are flag, anthem, picture, statues are symbols. Symbols are the short expression for the identification of an object or situation.

3. Norms

According to **John J. Maccionis**: *norms, rules are expectations by which a society guides the behavior of its members.* In everyday life, people respond to each other with sanctions, rewards or punishments that encourage conformity to cultural norms.

Norms as elements of culture are the rules and the guidelines which specify the behavior of an individual. Norms keep a person within the boundary of society and its culture. It gives us restriction about something which to do and which not to do. It molds our behavior and gives us knowledge about wrong and right. Norms can be divided into three types:

a. **Folkways: norms for routine or casual interaction (Maccionis).**

Folkways are the simple customary ways of the people. It is the normal and habitual action of people within a culture. Folkways are the recognized or accepted ways of behavior. These are the behavior pattern which a person use generally in his daily life.

b. **Mores: (pronounced "MORE-ayz") refer to norms that are widely observed and have great moral significance (Maccionis).**

Mores, which include taboos, are the norms in our society that insist, for example that adults not walk around in public without wearing clothes.

Mores refers to "what ought to be and what ought not to be." Mores are serious norms but are informal like folkways. They have a serious binding on a group the violation of mores threatens to social order. Punishment may be both formal and informal for the violation of mores.

(c) Law:

The third type is law, which is the strongest force enforced by government in a society. Law is an engine of social control. Law is passed in constituent assembly and enforced in society for the security of social and cultural values. Those who violate laws are called criminals. Crime is an act which cuts the law into pieces. It is a social problem creating sensation and disturbance in social life. Crime related to murder is called heinous crime.

Definitions:

Cohen & Orbach: Mores that have been formalized and have legal sanction attached to them.

According to Shankar Rao: "Written codes of life and conduct enforced by institutions and agencies are called law".

4. Values

According to John J. Maccionis: "**values are culturally defined standards that people use to decide what is desirable, good, and beautiful and that serve as broad guidelines for social living.** People who share a culture use values to make choices about how to live."

Anything getting importance in our daily life becomes our values. The origin of values is not biological but it is social production while living in society the values develop. Values depend upon the culture. Culture varies from society to society and thus values are different in every social situation. Values are what we like and what we say will in our society values are the good idea and thinking of a person.

Some values are hereditary which we gain from our elders, books and parents. The culture is full of values and can transmit from one generation to another. When a natural object get a meaning it becomes a value.

5. Beliefs

According to John J. Maccionis: *beliefs are specific thoughts or ideas that people hold to be true.*

Every sect within a culture having some beliefs for cultural refuge. These beliefs are responsible for the spiritual fulfillment of needs and wants. Muslims believe in God, Holy Prophet, The Day of Judgment, recitation of Holy Quran, Hajj etc. Sikh wear bangle in one hand, bear a long beard, keeping a dagger. Cross for Christians and a necklace or a cotton thread around neck, the water of Ganga and are sacred for Hindus.

6. Cognitive Elements

Cognitive elements of culture are those things which an individual knows how to cope with an existing social situation. How to survive, how to make shelter from storms and other natural calamities, how to travel and transport etc. are the practical knowledge which make a culture. Such knowledge is carefully thought to every generation.

CULTURAL DIVERSITY

Cultural diversity is the quality of diverse or different cultures, as opposed to monoculture, the global monoculture, or a homogenization of cultures, akin to cultural evolution. The term "cultural diversity" can also refer to having different cultures respect each other's differences.

Definition:

Dr. Caleb Rosado, defines cultural diversity as *"...a system of beliefs and behaviors that recognizes and respects the presence of all diverse groups in an organization or society, acknowledges and values their socio-cultural differences, and encourages and enables their continued contribution within an inclusive cultural context which empowers all within the organization or society."*

Explanation:

Essentially, cultural diversity is about bringing people together from a diverse set of backgrounds and cultures, then creating an environment that not only recognizes the differences between those cultures and backgrounds, but celebrates them. It helps create a safe space for people to be authentically themselves.

Diversity refers to the attributes that people use to confirm themselves with respect to others, "that person is different from me." These attributes include demographic factors (such as race, gender, and age) as well as values and cultural norms. The many separate societies that emerged around the globe differ markedly from each other, and many of these differences persist to this day. The more obvious cultural differences that exist between people are language, dress, and traditions. There are also significant variations in the way societies organize themselves, such as in their shared conception of morality, religious belief, and in the ways, they interact with their environment. Cultural diversity can be seen as analogous to biodiversity.



Cultural diversity is found among people on the basis of following dimensions:

Race, Ethnicity, Sexual orientation, Religion, Language, Gender, Age, and Disability.

The importance of cultural diversity can be interpreted on the basis of these related actions:

- Recognizing that there is a large amount of cultures that exist
- Respecting each other's differences
- Acknowledging that all cultural expressions are valid
- Valuing what cultures have to bring to the table
- Empowering diverse groups to contribute

- Celebrating differences, not just tolerating them
- Cultural diversity looks like this:

Benefits of Cultural Diversity

The world is naturally multicultural. Approaching cultural diversity with a mindset and actions that embrace this fact leads to many benefits, like:

- **Compassion:** Communication and understanding of differences leads to increased compassion instead of judgment.
- **Innovation:** Varied perspectives and lens of looking at the world lend to innovative thinking.
- **Productivity:** People who come together and bring their own style of working together tend to support a more productive team.
- **New Opportunities:** The diversity opens the door to new opportunities and the blending of ideas which would otherwise have been homogeneous.
- **Problem-Solving:** Challenges are layered, so having people with different backgrounds can lead to better problem-solving with richness of opinions.

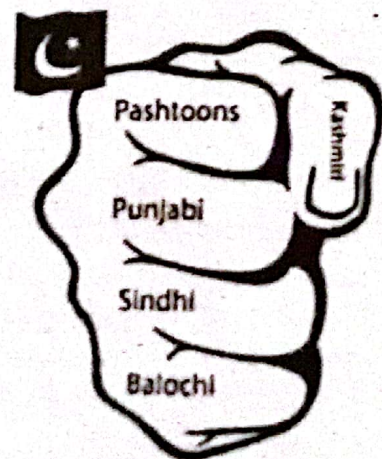
SUB-CULTURE

According to John J. Maccionis: *"cultural patterns that set apart some segment of a society's population."*

Explanation:

In one society, there may be a number of regional classes representing their respective ways of life distinctive from one another and from the whole culture. The culture of these classes of people, within the general culture of the whole society, is called sub-culture. For example, culture of Pakistani society has several sub-cultures in its various regions. Panjabi, Sindhi, Balochi and Pukhtoon people have their respective cultures different from one another and distinctive from the total culture of Pakistani society.

This Is Pakistan. 🇵🇰



Punjabi culture, however, is a part-culture contributing to the whole of Pakistani culture. Within one region, take for example, in Punjab there are a number of sub-cultural groups such as Lahori, Saraiki, Gujrati and Pothohari. These sub-cultures represent their respective distinction of local dialects in speech, terms of addressing others, styles of dresses and certain customary ways at the occasions of birth and marriage. There are numerous sub-cultures in one culture, on the basis of geographical, religious, economic and ancestral conditions. Sub-cultures are really the integral parts of the total culture and without that part the whole is not completed. The sub-culture is interrelated with, or interdependent upon the rest of the culture. With the exclusion of sub-cultures the whole cannot represent its entity.

Basis of Subculture

According to Sutherland, Woodward and Maxwell, the main sub-cultures are:

- regional sub-culture,
- ethnic or nationality sub-cultures,
- urban and rural sub-cultures,
- class sub-culture, occupational sub-culture, and
- the religious sub-culture.

Cultural Relativism

If we try to understand a foreign culture in terms of our values and motives, we will not be able to do so. Because our values and motives will bias our observation and our judgment will not be real. We must interpret and describe their behavior in the light of their motives, habits and values, if we are to understand them. It means to understand the society of a foreign culture we will have to apply the modes of the same society. For this purpose, a sociologist is required to undergo changes in his attitudes, motives, values and habits according to the social systems of the society which he wants to study. It is a sort of training for him. He must set his values aside and learn the habits and motives of the people of the new society.

Definition:

According to John J. Maccionis: *the practice of judging a culture by its own standards.*

Horton and Hunt: *"the function and meaning of a trait are relative to its cultural setting is called cultural diversity".*

A trait is neither good nor bad but it is good or bad only with reference to the culture in which it functions. The rite of Sati in Hindus and custom of Polyandry in Tibetans are its examples. The Hindus worship the sun, the river Ganges and the idols. These items of worship are fitted in Hindu culture. From these examples, we note that any cultural trait is socially "good" if it operates harmoniously within its cultural setting to attain the goals which the people are seeking.

ETHNOCENTRISM

Definition:

Summer defined ethnocentrism as *"that view of things in which ones', own group is the center of everything and all others are scaled and rated with reference to it."*

Horton and Hunt deduce that *"ethnocentrism is the habit of every group of taking for granted the superiority of its culture".*

Explanation:

It means that every culture considers itself superior to other cultures. The Americans think of themselves as the "Progressive" while the Eastern cultures call them immoral. The Pakistanis call themselves as brave, hard-worker and faithful people. The Arabs call themselves hospitable. Similarly, the people of every nation feel pride and claim superiority upon other nations. This sense of pride or superiority upon others is called ethnocentrism.

Even within a society different social groups are ethnocentric against one another. The agriculturists claim to be superior to laborers and the businessmen are proud upon low class servants. Similarly, high class officers think themselves higher upon other low class servants. This feeling of superiority upon others is universal among nations, groups and the individuals. This cultural trait is called ethnocentrism.

Positive Effects of Ethnocentrism

1. It encourages social solidarity in groups and in society by which the forces of co-operation become stronger.

2. It provides protection to group members by creating sense of belonging among them. Those members who are weak, poor, hopeless and helpless are encouraged by joining hands of ethnocentrism with them. It means it provides compensation to the people of low status.
3. It promotes nationalism and patriotism among the members of society. Because it stimulates the spirit of belonging to the society and culture claiming superiority to others.
4. Caste, Biradri and consanguine groups develop by ethnocentrism in which marriage and other social relations are facilitated.

Negative Effects of Ethnocentrism

1. Ethnocentrism creates tight boundaries among various social groups. The inter-group relations are hampered due to prejudice against one another. The process of social relations among various groups gets slower.
2. The prejudice created by ethnocentrism creates conflict and tension among various groups. The social forces of cooperation face problems in their operation.
3. Ethnocentrism limits an individual in a small social group to which he belongs. He remains within the limits of that group and is not influenced by the general social changes happening around him in the society. He remains backward in a sense by this way and adopts little changes. Sometimes even he preaches against modern social changes. It means it discourages culture change among the people.
4. The national development in general is slowed down in such cultures where ethnocentrism is emphasized in books, newspapers, radio and television.

DESCRIPTIVE QUESTIONS

1. Define culture and explain its chief characteristics
2. Explain major functions of culture
3. Define ethnocentrism, also explain merits and demerits of ethnocentrism
4. Write a note on elements of culture
5. Define culture. Also explain its type.

Short Questions and Answers

1. Define culture.

Ans.: Beals and Hoijer hold that a culture is "the totality of designs for living practiced by man at all places and times." Within all the time and space a culture is the mode of activities which differentiates the people of one society from another.

2. Explain Four Characteristics of Culture.

Ans.: i. **Culture is Learnt:** Culture is not inherited biologically, but learnt socially by man. It is not an inborn tendency. There is no cultural instinct as such. Culture is often called 'learned ways of behaviour'. Unlearned behaviour, such as closing the eyes while sleeping, the eye blinking reflex and so on, are purely physiological and not cultural. Shaking hands or saying 'Salam' or 'thanks' and shaving.

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Ans.: i. **Culture is the Treasury of Knowledge.** Culture provides knowledge which is essential for the physical, social and intellectual existence of man. Culture preserves knowledge and helps its transmission from generation to generation through its element, that is, language. Language helps not only

the transmission of knowledge but also its preservation, accumulation and diffusion. On the contrary, animals do not have this advantage. Because, culture does not exist at sub-human level.

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iv. Culture decides our Career. Whether we should become a politician, a social worker, a doctor, an engineer, a soldier, a farmer, a professor, an industrialist, a religious leader, and so on is decided by our culture. What career we are likely to pursue is largely decided by our culture.

4. Define material culture with example.

Ans.: Material culture, is the physical things created by members of a society, everything from armchairs to zippers.

Material culture consists of man-made objects such as tools, implements, furniture, automobiles, buildings, dams, roads, bridges, and in fact, the physical substance which has been changed and used by man. It is concerned with the external, mechanical and utilitarian objects. It includes technical and material equipment's like a printing press, a locomotive, a telephone, a television, a tractor, a machine gun, etc. It includes our banks, parliaments, insurance schemes, currency systems, etc.

5. Define nonmaterial culture with example.

Ans.: Non-Material Culture: Nonmaterial culture is the ideas created by members of a society, ideas that range from art to Zen.

The term 'culture' when used in the ordinary sense, means 'non-material culture'. It is something internal and intrinsically valuable, reflects the inward nature of man. Non-material culture consists of the words the people use or

the language they speak, the beliefs they hold, values and virtues they cherish, habits they follow, rituals and practices that they do and the ceremonies they observe. It also includes our customs and tastes, attitudes and outlook, in brief, our ways of acting, feeling and thinking.

6. Define ideal culture.

Ans.: The culture which is presented as a pattern or precedent to the people is called ideal. It is the goal of the society. It can never be achieved fully because some part of it remains out of practice. This culture is explained in books, speeches and guidances. The part of ideal culture practiced in social life is called real culture. Islam is our ideal culture. We claim to be true Muslims and this claim is our ideal culture but how far we are Muslims in practice is our real culture. Both the real and ideal cultures are related together and different from each other.

7. Define real culture.

Ans.: It is that culture which can be observed in our social life. The culture on which we act upon in our social life is real. The part of culture which the people adopt in their social life is their real culture. The whole of the culture is never real because a part of it remains without practice. How far we set upon Islam is our real culture. We are all Muslims but we do not follow Islam fully in our social life. It means the part of Islam which we follow is our real culture.

8. What are elements of culture?

Ans.: Elements of culture are: language, symbols, values, beliefs, norms and cognitive.

9. Define symbol?

Ans.: According to Maccionis: A symbol is anything that carries a particular meaning recognized by people who share a culture. A word, a whistle, a wall covered with graffiti, a flashing red light, a raised fist—all serve as symbols.

10. Define language.

Ans.: According to Maccionis: Language, the key to the world of culture, is a system of symbols that allows people to communicate with one another. Humans have created many alphabets to express the hundreds of languages we speak.

1. Define norms.

Ans.: Norms, rules and expectations by which a society guides the behavior of its members. In everyday life, people respond to each other with sanctions, rewards or punishments that encourage conformity to cultural norms.

12. Define values.

Ans.: Values, culturally defined standards that people use to decide what is desirable, good, and beautiful and that serve as broad guidelines for social living. People who share a culture use values to make choices about how to live.

13. Define beliefs.

Ans.: Beliefs, specific thoughts or ideas that people hold to be true.

Every sect within a culture having some beliefs for cultural refuge. These beliefs are responsible for the spiritual fulfillment of needs and wants. Muslims believe in God, Holy Prophet, The Day of Judgment, recitation of Holy Quran, Hajj etc. Sikh wear bangle in one hand, bear a long beard, keeping a dagger. Cross for Christians and a necklace or a cotton thread around neck, the water of Ganga and are sacred for Hindus.

14. Define Cultural Relativism.

Ans.: John J. Maccionis: cultural relativism, the practice of judging a culture by its own standards.

15. Define cultural diversity.

Ans.: Sociologist Dr. Caleb Rosado, a leading expert in multiculturalism, defines cultural diversity as "...a system of beliefs and behaviors that recognizes and respects the presence of all diverse groups in an organization or society, acknowledges and values their socio-cultural differences, and encourages and enables their continued contribution within an inclusive cultural context which empowers all within the organization or society."

16. Define subculture.

Ans.: John J. Maccionis: cultural patterns that set apart some segment of a society's population

17. Define ethnocentrism.

Ans.: Horton and Hunt: "the function and meaning of a trait are relative to its

cultural setting is called cultural diversity".

18. Explain Merits/Benefits of Ethnocentrism.

1. It encourages social solidarity in groups and in society by which the forces of co-operation become stronger.
2. It provides protection to group members by creating sense of belonging among them. Those members who are weak, poor, hopeless and helpless are encouraged by joining hands of ethnocentrism with them. It means it provides compensation to the people of low status.
3. It promotes nationalism and patriotism among the members of society. Because it stimulates the spirit of belonging to the society and culture claiming superiority to others.
4. Caste, Biradri and consanguine groups develop by ethnocentrism in which marriage and other social relations are facilitated.

19. Explain demerits of ethnocentrism.

1. Ethnocentrism creates tight boundaries among various social groups. The inter-group relations are hampered due to prejudice against one another. The process of social relations among various groups gets slower.
2. The prejudice created by ethnocentrism creates conflict and tension among various groups. The social forces of cooperation face problems in their operation.
3. Ethnocentrism limits an individual in a small social group to which he belongs. He remains within the limits of that group and is not influenced by the general social changes happening around him in the society. He remains backward in a sense by this way and adopts little changes. Sometimes even he preaches against modern social changes. It means it discourages culture change among the people.
4. The national development in general is slowed down in such cultures where ethnocentrism is emphasized in books, newspapers, radio and television.